

A History of All Saints' Episcopal Church

Concord, North Carolina

An illustrated history of the parish, its buildings, and its sacred objects, with a guide to the symbolism of the church, drawn from the parish history book.

A note on this edition

This is a clean, readable edition of the All Saints' parish history book, set in type so it can be read on screen or printed at home. Every fact, date, name, and quotation is preserved from the original book. A handful of plain typographical slips in the original (a doubled letter, a dropped letter) have been quietly corrected so the text reads smoothly; those corrections are listed at the end. Nothing of substance has been added, removed, or reworded. The original scanned pages remain available as a separate facsimile.

The picture history that opens the book pairs each illustration with the caption printed beneath it. The two longer sections that follow, *The Saint James Brass* and *Symbolism Used in All Saints' Episcopal Church*, are reproduced in full.

Part One: A Picture History

The Gibson Home

The home in Concord, North Carolina of Mr. and Mrs. James C. Gibson.

For many years a group of Episcopalians met in this home, having services in the parlor and Sunday School in the dining room.

All Saints, 1886–1892

This Presbyterian Church building was purchased for \$500.00 in 1886 and was used for many years as the Episcopal Church in Cabarrus County.

The Reverend J. C. Davis

The Reverend J. C. Davis of Athens, Georgia became the Rector of All Saints' in December, 1892. He was the priest for over 17 years.

The Cornerstone, 1891

"The Episcopal Church in Cabarrus County."

The cornerstone of All Saints' was dated November, 1891. This church is still standing on the corner of Cabarrus Avenue and Spring Street. The ivy covering part of its walls was brought from Westminster Abbey by Sister Mary Joseph, who was the sister of Emily Gibson and Julia Magruder.

The Triptych Window

This triptych window which was in the church on Cabarrus Avenue was moved to All Saints' in 1972. It is located in the Children's Chapel and was given in fond memory of Reverend John Thomas Wheat, D.D., Rector 1877–1881. The Sunday School Children and other members of the church helped fund this memorial.

The Bonaparte Chandeliers

The antique chandeliers were presented to All Saints' Episcopal Church from Mrs. Ada Rogers Gorman as a tribute to her mother Mrs. Martha Rogers on May 8, 1937.

A Brief History

Prince deRohan Bonaparte, a cousin of Napoleon Bonaparte, had these four chandeliers along with twelve others of the same size and a much larger one in his palace in what is now the Latin Quarter of Paris. This palace became in time the property of the Nation, being one of the great show places in Paris. During the World War I this palace was hit by shells and much damage was done. After the war, the building was declared unsafe and was dismantled, the furnishings being offered at auction.

Mr. Feldman, who with his five sons had three antique shops on the Rue de Royal in New Orleans, heard of this auction and went to Paris where he purchased the sixteen smaller chandeliers and the very large one. The large one is in a Jewish Temple in New Orleans today. The other twelve are in different parts of the country lighting up assembly halls and perhaps other churches as well.

Each of the four chandeliers at All Saints' holds twenty lights placed artistically amid the tracery of gold leaf, while from concentric circles are suspended prisms that give a soft tone to the lighting. Streaming from the crown above each chandelier are strings of crystal beads.

Mrs. Ada Rogers Gorman gave these as a tribute to her mother, Mrs. Martha Rogers in 1937. The chandeliers were moved from the old church on Cabarrus Avenue and are now in the nave of our church today.

The Mission Church in Kannapolis: St. James Episcopal

In the early 1940's, twenty-four interested Episcopalians gathered in an empty house at 303 Sloop Avenue to begin forming a mission church in Kannapolis. Mr. and Mrs. G.G. Allen offered the house and the property for the church.

St. James Episcopal Church, 1953–1968

In 1947 funds for the building on Cook Street were collected. The Reverend Martin Caldwell became Vicar from 1952–1954. It was under his leadership that "a dream that began a decade before became a reality" for St. James Church in Kannapolis. The first service was held on April 13, 1954.

Declaration of Secularization

When the congregation left the Cabarrus Avenue church in 1972, the old building was formally returned to secular use. The original document is reproduced here; the handwritten entries appear in italics.

DECLARATION OF SECULARIZATION The Episcopal Diocese of North Carolina

In the Name of God, Amen.

FORASMUCH as on the *27th* day of *April*, in the year of our Lord, *1904*, by our predecessor, *Joseph B. Cheshire*, Bishop of the Diocese of *North Carolina*, according to the order of the Protestant Episcopal Church in the United States of America, this fabric was duly consecrated and hallowed by the name of (Saint) *All Saints'* Church; and

Forasmuch as his Sentence of Consecration has been full of force and effect until this date;

We, *Thomas A. Fraser*, Bishop of the Diocese aforesaid, do hereby declare said Sentence of our Right Reverend predecessor to be revoked and canonically annulled, and do hereby revoke and annul the same, and to remit this fabric and the appurtenances thereof to secular and common uses for any lawful and reputable employment by honest men, for their good and honourable work, business, or profession, according to the laws of this land.

And this fabric, accordingly, is hereby forever secularized, and the Sentence aforesaid is voided and revoked, and this place, heretofore a holy place, and sacred to the preaching of God's holy Word, and the ministration of his holy Sacraments, is hereby pronounced secular and unconsecrated, and no longer within our canonical jurisdiction, but given back solely to the protection of the laws of the land, and to none other than such common uses and secular control as by said laws are recognized and allowed.

Given under our hand and seal, in the City of *Concord*, State of *North Carolina*, and before divers witnesses duly published within the walls of the fabric aforesaid, on this *10th* day of *July*, in the year of our Lord God and Saviour Jesus Christ one thousand nine hundred and *seventy-two*.

Signed, *Thomas A. Fraser*, Bishop of North Carolina *W. Parker Marks*, Rector, All Saints Episcopal Church

All Saints Parish: Proposed Plans, Advent 1970

All Saints' Episcopal Church, Concord, North Carolina. Proposed Plans for "The Episcopal Church in Cabarrus County." All Saints Parish, Concord–Kannapolis, North Carolina. Advent 1970. (The cross in the drawing reads: "The Glory of God Ye Build.")

On January 1, 1969, All Saints' and St. James held congregational meetings with both churches approving the merger to form a stronger church to witness to Christ. Plans were drawn up for the current church building.

All Saints Episcopal Church, 1972

A four year program establishing "The Episcopal Church in Cabarrus County" climaxed on October 22, 1972 as Bishop Thomas A. Fraser dedicated the ultra-modern \$270,000 church which completed the merger of All Saints and St. James Parish.

Symbolism of the All Saints Reredos

Dedicated to Samuel I. Parker. A Tribute to Samuel I. Parker from Sam Stroup.

Just as the panels represents cathedral windows radiating sunshine and the columns show strength, so does the reredos radiate, in its panels, his optimism and cheerfulness. The columns show the strength of this most decorated soldier.

Easter 1980.

The All Saints Reredos

A reredos is a screen or partition behind the altar. Some churches use a curtain of fabric ornamented with Christian symbols. The reredos may be made of wood or stone but some may be very elaborate. A great Byzantine reredos contains many enameled figures and uncut precious stones.

The reredos was used because unlettered early Christians needed the symbolism. Statues were not used for fear the Christians would return to the worship of idols or images.

Mrs. Jane Liles was chairman of the committee to provide a reredos in memory of Samuel I. Parker. Sam Stroup submitted a design to the committee and the church. When it was approved, Southern Desk Company made and installed the reredos as charged, "Match the furniture but keep the design simple."

It was necessary to add a step in the sanctuary so that there would be the traditional three steps up to the altar from the nave. It also added height to the altar.

In order to allow more space on the altar a free standing retable (or rear table) was included in the plan. This allowed the altar to be moved out so that the priest can face the congregation without disturbing the cross or flowers.

The three step retable, representative of the Trinity, provided spaces for the candlesticks and vases for flowers, the Vesper candlesticks used when there is no Eucharist, the flowers which symbolize the resurrection. The retable adds height for the cross which should always be visible to the congregation just as the altar should always be visible down the center aisle.

The reredos contains five ornamental panels across the back and one at each end making a total of seven. The number seven was considered a "complete" number even before the Christian era. The design of the panels is a remnant of the Gothic arch used in early cathedrals. This enabled them to construct high vaulted ceilings. They consist of three portions of circles, another symbol of the Trinity.

The All Saints' Organ

The golden age of organ building was the eighteenth century. It served its most important role in the worship of the church and more important composers wrote for the instruments during this period than at any other time. The concept of the organ today has returned to that of the eighteenth century and as such the instrument is enjoying a great renaissance.

The organ at All Saints' was built in accordance with these principles by the Schlicker Organ Company in Buffalo, New York. Mr. Herman Schlicker in consultation with Mr. Henry Bridges of the Community School of the Arts of Charlotte and the Organ Committee, chaired by Dr. David Lockhart, worked out a specification especially designed for the worship and building of our church.

There are 656 pipes in the organ, each made by hand. The metal pipes are made out of a 75% virgin tin alloy. The lowest note is produced by a stopped wooden pipe eight feet long. The highest note is produced by a very thin pipe with a speaking length of less than one half inch. The organ is built of such quality as to function for many years to come and is ideally suited to the accompaniment of congregational singing, liturgy, anthems and to the performance of solo organ pieces especially suited to the size of All Saints' Church.

The 21 note set of Maryland Chimes was given in memory of Miss Isabelle Whitefield, Mrs. Mildred Mitchell Goodman, and Mrs. Mary Fisher Isenhour.

The Columbarium at All Saints'

The Columbarium is a special structure containing an arrangement of recessed niches to hold crematorium urns. William F. Freeman, an architect from High Point, designed the structure. Dr. David Lockhart designed the wrought iron gates marking the entrance to the garden. It was completed on December 22, 1985 and dedicated in memory of Susan Frances Lockhart by the Rt. Reverend Robert W. Estill in January, 1986.

The Victorian Angel

The lovely Victorian angel sculpted from Carrara marble in Italy, and holding a bowl at its waist, has served since 1908 as the Baptismal Font for All Saints' Church. It was a gift from Mrs. Ada Rogers Gorman.

The All Saints' Parish Banner

The All Saints' banner was designed in memory of Fenner Hammond Springs McCoy, a textile consultant in Concord for most of his life, and Myrtle Louise McCoy, a well known local artist.

The banner was made in England by J. Wippell and Company of Exeter. This unique work was designed with Mr. McCoy's textile background in mind and the artistic flair of Mrs. McCoy.

The banner features a flaming sword and stylized crown, both symbols of saints and martyrs. The banner was dedicated on All Saints' Day, 1985.

Part Two: The Saint James Brass

A brief history by Sam Stroup. The altar and brass from St. James Church is located in the Children's Chapel at All Saints' today.

In the early 1940's, a group of interested Episcopalians gathered in an empty four room house on Sloop Street in Kannapolis. Mr. and Mrs. George G. Allen offered the house and property for a church in Kannapolis. It was unanimously agreed to form a mission church there. It was inspired by a branch of the All Saints women's auxiliary which had been active in Kannapolis.

The men of the church did the necessary carpentry to remodel the house for use as a church. Two rooms were put together to form a nave and sanctuary. Bruce Lyerly, James C. Walker, and Hubert Lyerly made a beautiful altar out of old air dried walnut which was extremely hard. Hubert Lyerly hand carved "Holy Holy Holy" out of walnut for the retable. They are beautiful. He still has them.

Samuel B. Stroup in a rash moment agreed to make the altar brass even though he had no idea how it would be done. He drew an ecclesiastical design for each piece with church symbolism in mind. A separate drawing was made for each piece, the altar cross, the processional cross, the Eucharistic candlesticks, and the missal stand.

The design drawings were used to make wooden patterns to be used in casting each item. The candlesticks were turned on a wood lathe to form an exact pattern. It was glued so that it could be split in the middle so that the round surface could be cast in the moistened sand and clay mold. Each half was formed in the sand and put together to form the whole.

He paid Mooresville Iron Works in Mooresville to make the rough castings of brass. The castings were returned with a very rough sand finish. They turned out to be extremely hard to break through and polish. James C. Walker was invaluable for his work on the flat surfaces with sander and milling machine. The round surfaces were turned and polished on a metal lathe by Stroup. It was long and tedious work.

Stroup gave the finished items to St. James with the suggestion that some of them be used as memorials in return for a contribution to a building fund.

Symbolism played an important role in the design and making of the altar brass for St. James. As with all Christian art, the symbolism should add beauty to the glory of God.

Church symbolism was in existence long before the printed word. Early Bibles as well as other Christian writings were hand written. Most were written by monks in their monasteries. Books were in very short supply. Most church goers were unable to read until after the invention of the printing press. It thus follows that the church depended on visible signs to convey the love of God through Christ. It is still an important part of our Christian worship today.

The Altar Cross

There are eight or more styles of crosses. All of them represent the crucifixion of Jesus. Many early crosses were made of silver and gold. The Crucifix has a realistic figure for portraying the crucifixion. Crosses in any style should be a reminder of Christ's suffering for us. The whole cross is still a symbol representing Christ's Passion on the cross that we might have forgiveness of sins. Crosses may be made of any size or shape and may be made of any material. The symbolism is the same since one should never tire of looking at it.

The cross is Botonic style. This means it has three "flower" buds on each arm. Just as the shamrock was used to explain the Trinity, so do these three knobs on each arm of the cross. They are also representative of flower buds, and thus remind one of the resurrection.

If one sees any part of the cross, the base or any of the three arms, one is reminded of the Trinity; Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The center of the cross contains the letters IHS. There are two meanings attributed to these letters, one being the abbreviation for Jesus. The other is the first letters of "Jesu Hominem Savum" meaning Jesus the Savior of Men.

The cross made for St. James was hand made and it was full of symbolism. Because it was hand made by amateurs it is full of flaws and defects such as sand pits and scratches. There can never be a perfect cross on which one was crucified.

The altar cross was given in memory of Margaret Terrisa Walter and presented by her daughter, Vivian Walter. Miss Walter was a long-time employee of Cabarrus Bank and Trust Co. and well known in the community. She was not a member of St. James, but a friend of the church.

The Processional Cross

The processional cross was made at the same time as the altar cross. The symbolism is the same as the altar cross. In addition, it has the letters PX on the back. These are the Greek letters Chi Ro, another symbol for Christ. The walnut for the staff came from a friend in

Rockwell. The early processional crosses were unscrewed from the staff and placed upon the altar. Thus the use of the processional is older than that of the altar cross. The St. James cross may not be unscrewed.

The St. James processional cross is in memory of Richard Breckenridge Harris and was presented by his daughter, Pearl Harris Trinchler. The Trinchers were active members of St. James in all areas. He was the manager of a theatre here.

The Candlesticks

The priest of the early churches required candle light at the altar to be able to read the Bible, Missal or Prayer Book. They were placed on the altar and were of two kinds. Branch candlesticks were used at all services to provide light and were named vesper candles because they had to be lighted in the evening. Two larger candlesticks were provided and when lighted they indicated that it was a service of the Eucharist. The one on the side from which the Gospel is read is called the "Gospel" candle. The other is the "Epistle" candle. These two altar candles represent the human and divine natures of Christ. They are most significant because Jesus designated Himself as "The Light of the World." The candles themselves are of beeswax, an emblem of purity.

One can use the Trinity in both the three step base of the candlestick and its top. It can also be seen in the ornamental ferrule or knob in the middle of the stick. The total of eleven steps represent the eleven faithful Apostles.

One Eucharistic candlestick was dedicated to Samuel Bradley Stroup, Priest, June 30, 1885 – March 25, 1947. He was the father of Samuel B. Stroup, Jr. who made the altar brasses for St. James Church in Kannapolis.

One Eucharistic candlestick was dedicated in memory of Herbert Hanes Moore who was the father of "Jazzy" Moore, founder and publisher of the Daily Independent. He was an active member of St. James.

The Vesper Candlesticks

The vesper candlesticks were presented by David Clinton Stroup a year before his death. He was the son of Sam and Helen Stroup. He was an invalid in a wheel chair. He enjoyed the candles and expected them to be respected and lighted in proper order. The six vesper candlesticks were made after the new church building was built. They were made for David to present to the church. He was very proud to give them to Bishop Penick to be dedicated.

These six small candlesticks are smaller duplicates of the Gospel and Epistle candlesticks and have the same symbols. They are usually placed in groups of three because of the variations of the three branch candlesticks used to symbolize the Trinity. They are called Vesper candles and may be used at all services whereas the Gospel and Epistle candles are only lighted for Eucharist.

There is another paper that gives even more symbolism for these candlesticks.

The candlesticks of any church are most symbolic. In addition to the important symbolism of a candle representing "Jesus, the Light of the World," our lights have many more meanings. From the flame of one candle millions may be lighted without diminishing the original flame. It is so with the Holy Spirit, continually being imparted, yet always the same.

The most important candlesticks are the Eucharistic candles which represent the Human and Divine natures of Christ. The candle on the left facing the altar is called the Gospel candle and should not be lit without the accompanying light. For this reason the Gospel candle is always lighted after the Epistle candle and extinguished first. You will notice that the Epistle is usually read from the right side of the altar and the Gospel is usually read from the left side, thus furnishing the names for the Eucharistic candles.

The six candles placed on the retablo of the altar represent the day and time of our Lord's crucifixion. He was crucified on Friday which is the sixth day of the week. They are placed in groups of three to symbolize the Holy Trinity: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. These candles are used when there is music and are called "office lights." They are properly used at a communion service when there are hymns sung. They are not usually used when there is no music as at an early communion. They are often lighted when there is a vesper service with no communion.

Beeswax candles are usually burned in church candlesticks since beeswax is the emblem of purity. The base of our candlesticks is in three steps and symbolize Faith, Hope, and Charity. The top base is Faith, the second base is Hope, and the bottom base is Charity. The knob in the center of the candlestick is made of five steps which symbolize the five wounds of Christ on the cross, two in his hands, two in his feet, and one in his side. The top steps of the candlesticks also symbolize the Holy Trinity.

The church service begins when the candles are lighted and does not end until they are extinguished. While they are burning the Light of Jesus is still in our presence and those at the service should remain in their pew until the acolyte has left the sanctuary after the candles are extinguished.

While there is much symbolism in our candlesticks, the most important bit of symbolism is the light or flame itself. "The Light of the World."

The Missal Stand

The book on the altar is called a missal. It is so named because it is a variation of the prayer book and may contain more or less than The Book of Common Prayer. The missal and missal stand are for the convenience of the priest. It matches the rest of the St. James brass.

The missal stand is given in memory of Amanda Linn Roberts and was presented by James Clay Walker. Mrs. Roberts was the grandmother of James C. Walker and raised him as a child. Mr. Walker was important in all the St. James brass. He was responsible for the finish of the flat surfaces of the missal stand and both crosses.

Part Three: Symbolism Used in All Saints' Episcopal Church

Compiled by Rev. W. Parker Marks, Former Rector.

The All Saints Altar Cross

The Cross Bontonee or Roman Budded Cross.

Explanation of The All Saints Altar Cross:

- **A.** IHS – first three letters in the Greek name "Jesus". On the back side of the Cross at this location is the Greek CHI-RHO, the first letter in the Greek word, "Christ".
- **B.** Fleur De Lis – symbolic of the Trinity.
- **C.** St. Matthew – symbolized by a winged creature with a man's face because Matthew's Gospel account traces Jesus' human genealogy.
- **D.** St. John – symbolized by an eagle because John's Gospel account rises to loftiest heights when speaking of Jesus and His work.
- **E.** St. Mark – symbolized by a winged creature with the head of a lion. Mark's Gospel account begins with "The voice of one crying in the wilderness", suggestive of the roar of a lion.
- **F.** Luke – symbolized by a winged creature with the head of an ox, the animal of sacrifice, since Luke's Gospel account stresses the atoning sacrifice of Jesus.

Note: Matthew, John, Mark, and Luke are the Four Evangelists (evangel = Greek, "good news"), as they bring the Good News of Jesus Christ.

- **G.** Sun and Moon – symbolizes that Christ is Lord of day and night (time), things visible and invisible, and life and death. On the back side of the Cross at this location are the Alpha and Omega, the first and last letters of the Greek alphabet, symbolizing the beginning and the end (eternity).
- **H.** Quatrefoils (set of four leaves) – symbolize the four Evangelists and the four cardinal virtues, Prudence, Justice, Temperance, and Fortitude (Wisdom 8:7).
- **I.** Cross Grade – the three steps, from top down, stand for Faith, Hope, and Love.

Note: The Saint James Altar Cross presently used in the Library Chapel is also a Roman Budded Cross, with the IHS (first three Greek letters in "Jesus"). This Cross and matching candles were designed and made by Samuel B. Stroup, a member of All Saints.

The Christ Window (Located Over the Altar)

Faceted glass windows are created by embedding thick pieces of glass in a strong epoxy, and covering the epoxy with sand. The great brilliance is achieved by having the colored glass protrude beyond the epoxy surface. Because of the strong refraction utilized in the process, the windows are less than 50% glass.

I. Trinity Panel. A composite of symbols reminding us that God Himself is the Source of all things and of all knowledge.

- a. Three Circles. Three: the Trinity (God). Circles: Eternity, unending.
- b. Two Triangles. Triangles: the Trinity (God). The two triangles are interlocked forming the Star of David, reminding us of God's revelation of Himself to the Hebrews. Also known as the Creator Star.
- c. A Cross is emblazoned over the composite of symbols to remind us of God's perfect revelation in Jesus Christ.

II. Christ Panel. The Reigning Christ, the focal point of this window.

- a. The Crown and scepter over His head symbolize his Reigning Glory.
- b. The extended left hand symbolizes His calling all men unto Himself.
- c. The right hand symbolizes His Benediction of Peace for all who come to Him.
- d. The word ALLELUIA is Latin meaning "Praise the Lord."

III. Old Testament Panel. Reminds us of our heritage from God's "chosen People of Israel."

- a. Staff and Knife – symbolizes Abraham, the Father of the Hebrews. Staff, symbolizes his position as Patriarch. Knife, symbolizes his strong faith revealed in the intended offering of his son, Isaac, as a sacrifice to God.
- b. The Burning Bush – Under the leadership of Moses, God welded together his scattered and enslaved people. The symbol of the Burning Bush reminds us of Moses' call "to deliver (my people) out of the hands of the Egyptians" (Exodus 3:8), and to lead them into the Promised Land.

- c. The Mantel and the Fiery Chariot – Elijah the prophet who, above all others, symbolizes the prophetic Voice of God to his people. The Mantel symbolizes the prophetic responsibility, which Elijah laid upon the shoulders of Elisha, his successor. The Fiery Chariot symbolizes the legend of Elijah's being taken up into Heaven.

Note: Moses and Elijah together symbolize the "Law and the Prophets", the most ancient division of the Hebrew Scripture. Moses is the "Law-Giver" and Elijah, "The Prophet". The Hebrew Scripture "Law and the Prophets" was fulfilled in the Person and Work of Jesus Christ.

- d. Gloria – Latin, meaning praise, honor, magnificence, etc. It is an exclamation of praise to God's Presence.

IV. The New Testament Panel. Based upon the great "I Am" sayings in St. John's Gospel account.

- "I am the Bread of Life" (John 6:35 – wheat)
- "I am the Light of the World" (John 8:12 – torch)
- "I am the Door" (John 10:9 – door)
- "I am the Good Shepherd" (John 10:11 – staff)
- "I am the Resurrection and the Life" (John 11:25 – torch, gate)
- "I am the Way, Truth, and Life" (John 14:6 – all)
- "I am the Vine" (John 15:1 – intertwined colors in glass)

The "I AM" sayings are climaxed in John 8:31-59, when Jesus tells the Jews: "Truly, truly, I say to you, before Abraham was, I AM" . . . and they attempted to stone him for blasphemy. Jesus was associating His Person and Work with God, Himself. In Exodus 3:3-14 God reveals to Moses that His Name is "I AM who I AM", and directs Moses to tell the Israelites that "I AM has sent me to you."

The word SANCTUS in the lower portion of this panel is the Latin "Holy", denoting purity, perfection, and blinding separateness from the profane.

V. John the Baptist Panel. It was John whom God used to bridge the chasm between the Old Testament revelation (Panel III) and his revelation in our Lord Jesus Christ (Panel II). The ancient symbol of the Lamb and Flag used for Saint John the Baptist ties together God (Panel I), the Old Testament or Old Covenant (Panel III), and God's revelation in Christ, the New Testament or New Covenant (Panel III).

VI. Virgin Mary Panel. Mary was God's willing human instrument for the event of the Incarnation. The symbol used here for the Blessed Virgin Mother is:

- The stylized letter "M"
- A Cross centered in and rising out of the "M".
- A Lily symbolizing purity, love, and willingness.

This panel ties together God (Panel I), the Son (Panel II), and the work of the Son (Panel IV).

The Saints Window (Located in the Choir Loft)

I. The Christ Panel. The Greek letters CHI and RHO are the monogram of the first two letters of the Greek word for Christ. CHI = X; RHO = P; XPISTOS. This topmost panel reminds us that the saints are citizens of the Kingdom of which Christ is the Head.

II. The Saint Peter Panel. The figure of Saint Peter stands under the "Keys to the Kingdom" (see Matthew 16:13-23), which symbolizes Peter's confession of faith as the key to our entering the Kingdom of God. Peter holds in his right hand a Cross and in his left hand the scroll naming the saints of God (Revelation 6:9-11).

III. The Saint James the Great Panel.

- a. Symbols representing the Voice of God breaking through the clouds on the mountain top where Peter, James, and John experienced our Lord's Transfiguration in the presence of Moses and Elijah. (See Matthew 17:1-8; Mark 9:2-8; Luke 9:28-36).
- b. The Seal of Saint James the Great contains: (i) The scallop shell, symbol of his pilgrimages by the sea. (ii) The sword of martyrdom, symbolizing that he was the first of the Apostles to give his life for the faith (See Acts 12:2).

Note: Saint James (referred to as "The Great" in contrast to Saint James "The Less", the brother of our Lord) is always listed among the closest inner circle of Christ's apostles. Very little is known about him. He was the brother of Saint John, the Apostle (not the Evangelist, writer of the Fourth Gospel). These two brothers were the sons of Zebedee, a fisherman. Noted for their quick tempers, they were given the nickname "sons of thunder" (Mark 3:17). James is the patron saint of Spain, but it is unlikely that any of the legends connecting him to that country have substance.

- c. The Olive Branch – symbolizing St. James' close presence to our Lord in the Garden of Gethsemane on the night before his death.

IV. The All Saints Panel.

- a. Three fish fashioned into a triangle for Trinity. The fish is one of the oldest Christian symbols. The letters F-I-S-H in Greek comprise initials for the phrase "Jesus Christ, Son of God, Savior". The fish was a secret greeting sign for Christians during times of persecution. The Trinity form reminds us that God was incarnate in Christ.
- b. All Saints Seal:
 - i. The Wings at the top of the seal remind us that the saints in heaven are at one with the saints on earth.
 - ii. The Crown symbolizes the "Crown of Life" for all the saints who follow in the Way of the Master. The crown is often used to symbolize Christ's Reign in Glory.
 - iii. The Cross of Triumph symbolizes the triumph of the Gospel throughout the earth. The Cross is a kingly gold and the earth is green, a symbol of life and growth. The blue insets above the cross symbolize heaven.
 - iv. The Alpha and Omega, first and last letters of the Greek alphabet, on either side of the Cross of Triumph symbolize the eternity of the Kingdom of God.
 - v. The Dogwood Branch at the bottom of the seal recalls our Lord's saying: "I am the Vine, you are the branches" (John 15:5). We are reminded that Christ is the source of our life both on earth and in heaven.
- c. The Mission Cross. This cross, with its arms pointing to the four points of the compass, symbolizes our Lord's command for his people to "go into all the world" with the message of His saving Gospel. (Matthew 28:19)

V. The Saint Stephen Panel. Saint Stephen, Deacon, was the first Christian martyr. Stephen's cloak reminds us that Saul, later called Paul, consented to his death by stoning. (Acts 7:54 – 8:1)

VI. The Saint Paul Panel. St. Paul was the great missionary who first carried the Gospel into Europe.

- a. The Seal of Saint Paul reminds us that even among the staunchest of the Pharisees and traditionalists were those who came to faith in God's revelation in Jesus Christ.
- b. The open Bible and the Sword symbolize the Word of God as "the Sword of the Spirit" (Gladius Spiritus).

The Sacramental Windows (Located in the Parlor Area)

A Sacrament is "an outward and visible sign of an inward and spiritual grace given unto us; ordained by Christ Himself, as a means whereby we receive this grace, and a pledge to assure us thereof." (Prayer Book, page 292)

There are two Sacraments: Holy Baptism and Holy Communion. In Baptism we are by the grace of God made members of the One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church. In the Holy Communion (or Eucharist, Greek for "Thanksgiving") we receive in a special way the living Presence of Jesus Christ, and gain strength for our lives.

I. The Holy Baptism Window (left side). "Go and Baptize all Nations In The Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit" (The Great Commandment of Matthew 28:19). The Shell dripping Water symbolizes the Sacrament of Baptism.

- A. The Hand of God (Manus Dei) pointing downward from a Cloud of Glory symbolizes both the creative Power of God and His openness to all people. The tri-radiant nimbus behind the Hand signifies divinity.
- B. The Descending Dove is the earliest symbol for the presence of the Holy Spirit, and is based on the account of our Lord's Baptism. (Matthew 3:16; Mark 1:10; Luke 3:22; John 1:32)
- C. The Font reminds of our own Baptism, who baptizes our Lord, and shortly afterwards proclaimed Him "Lamb of God."

II. The Holy Communion Window (right side). "This is My Body and This is My Blood. Do this in remembrance of Me." (from the Last Supper)

- A. The Chalice and Communion Bread symbolize the Blessed Sacrament of our Lord's Body and Blood. The Cross of Saint Chad, Bishop of Litchfield, England (died 679) reminds us of the great sacrifice that Christ anticipated as he instituted this Supper.
- B. The PAX (Latin "Peace") calls us to the "Peace of God which passes all understanding."
- C. The Grapes symbolize the Blood (Wine) of our Lord Jesus Christ.
- D. The Fleur-de-lis (French "Flower of the Lily") symbolizes the Holy Trinity and reminds us of the Triune Nature of God.
- E. The Wheat symbolizes the Body (Bread) of our Lord Jesus Christ.

The Seasonal Windows

I. The Creation Window. "In the beginning was the Word and the Word was God" (Saint John 1:1)

- A. The Holy Name "YAHWEH" (Hebrew, "The Lord") is centered in a Circle, symbolizing eternity. The rays emanating from the Circle symbolize the blinding Glory of the Lord God.
- B. The three Circles (symbolizing eternity) intertwined with the Triangle symbolize the Godhead as the Three Persons of the Trinity – Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.
- C. (and E) The ALPHA and OMEGA (left and right sides respectively) are the first and last letters of the Greek alphabet, and symbolize the beginning and the end; that the Lord was before all time and is beyond all time, and that all things are under His Providence.
- D. The Fish is one of the oldest Christian symbols. The letters in the Greek word "fish" compose the initials of the acrostic phrase meaning "Jesus Christ, Son of God, Savior". We are reminded that the most perfect revelation of the Lord God is Jesus Christ.

Note: The Scripture in the window reminds us that Jesus Christ is the Incarnation of the Creative Power of God – that "The Word became flesh and dwelt among us" (John 1:14). God Said, (God spoke His word – Genesis 1:f.) and all things came into being; the very Creative Word of God came supremely to us in Christ, the Word of God in human form.

Note: This Creation Window does not commemorate a Church Season, but rather places our windows in the context of God's eternity.

II. The Advent Window. "Prepare the way of the Lord" (St. Matthew 3:3, etc.) "The Kingdom of God is at hand." (St. Matthew 3:2, etc.)

- a. The "TAU" Cross (so called because of resemblance to the Greek letter "tau") is the original form of the Cross. Also called the Cross of Prophecy or Advent Cross. The Sun of Righteousness rises in flaming glory, symbolizing the Advent ("coming") of the Christ ("Messiah").
- b. The Flaming Torch symbolizes the burning prophecy of the righteous God, calling men to repent and prepare for the coming of the Messiah.
- c. The Anchor Cross symbolizes salvation from sin through the merits of the Savior's death and resurrection, and hope in life eternal – the hope that is promised to us all in Jesus Christ. "Anchored in Faith!"

- d. The Shell and Flag symbolize John the Baptist, who prepared the way of the Lord. John is the central Advent character.
- e. A variation on the Anchor Cross.

"Behold a virgin shall conceive and bear a son . . ." (Isaiah 7:14)

III. The Christian Window. "And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us" (John 1:14)

- a. The Manger in the radiant glory of the Star symbolizes the Incarnation Event.
- b. The Christmas Rose symbolizes the Virgin Mary.
- c. IHS, the first letters of the Greek name, "Jesus", and CHI RHO, the first letters of the Greek name, "Christ".
- d. The Carpenter's Mallet and Square symbolize Saint Joseph, our Lord's human father. We are further reminded that Jesus was trained in this work.

Note: The Scripture in the window heralds back to the Creation.

ANGEL (Hebrew and Greek, "Messenger"). A heavenly being created by God and who stands in His presence ready to do His bidding.

IV. The Epiphany Window. "We have seen His star and have come to worship Him." (Matthew 2:3) "I am the way, the truth, and the life." (John 14:16, and others)

- a. The Epiphany (Greek, "manifestation") Star reminds us that through the manifestation of the Star to the wise men the Incarnate Word ("King") was made known to the Gentile peoples.
- b. The Egyptian Forms symbolize the Holy Family's flight into Egypt to escape Herod's jealous wrath.
- c. The Candle symbolizes that the Light of God shone even through the darkness of men's hearts. (John 1:6-13)
- d. The Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh remind us of the gifts brought by the wise men. These three gifts have great symbolic value:
 - i. Gold represents our gifts of substance, material things.
 - ii. Frankincense because of its fragrance represents our inner treasure of thought and influence, intangible gifts.
 - iii. Myrrh because of its use in medicine and embalming represents our sorrow and suffering, the "bitter gift." Because of their great value, these gifts were considered

appropriate for a monarch.

- e. The Knife symbolizes Herod's murder of the young male children in an effort to rid himself of the King for whom the wise men searched. We are reminded that the world often seeks to do away with God's Word.

V. The Lent Window. "Is it nothing to you and all you who pass by?" (Lamentations 1:12)

- a. The Cross and Crown of Thorns symbolize the Passion and Death of our Lord.
- b. The Whips symbolize the ridicule and scourging of our Lord.
- c. The Palm Branches symbolize our Lord's Triumphant entry into Jerusalem the Sunday before his death.
- d. The Cup of Submission and the pointed Cross of Agony symbolize the Last Supper, instituted by our Lord on the night before His Death. This Cross of Agony also symbolizes His agony in the Garden of Gethsemane.
- e. The Purse and Thirty Pieces of Silver symbolize our Lord's betrayal and arrest.

Note: Crosses (Left to right):

1. Maltese Cross – Crusade origin, used by the Hospitallers, whose headquarters was in Malta. Known also as the Regeneration Cross, symbolizing new birth (expanding from the center), with the eight outer points symbolizing the Beatitudes.
2. Latin (Roman) Cross – Very old and most used Cross symbol.
3. Saint Andrew's Cross – Andrew requested to be crucified on a cross unlike that of his Lord.
4. Tau Cross – Original form of the cross. Used for crucifixions.
5. Cross Crosslet – Represents Christianity spreading in four directions. Often used as Mission Cross.
6. Celtic Cross (or Cross of Iona) – The circle (eternity) symbolizes Christ's sacrifice for all people of all times.
7. Patriarchal Cross – Upper (shorter) cross arm represents the inscription that was placed over our Lord's head.
8. Bottonnee (Budded) Cross – The trefoil ends remind us that God (the Three In One) made His perfect Sacrifice in Jesus Christ.
9. Anchor Cross – Symbolizes salvation by our Lord's Death and Resurrection, and hope in life eternal. ("Anchored in the Faith")

10. Greek Cross – Old variation of the Cross.
11. Passion ("Agony") Cross – The pointed ends remind us of the sharpness of our Lord's agony.
12. Crux Ansata – From the key-like Egyptian "ankh", a symbol of life and immortality. Christians appropriated this as a symbol.

The Scripture in the window, first written to confess sorrow over the destruction of Jerusalem by the Babylonians (586 B.C.) reminds us to consider the tragedy of man's sin that caused the great sacrifice. The Plumb Line: God's Righteous Judgment and "Behold, I am setting a plumb line in the midst of my people." (Amos 7:8)

VI. The Easter Window. "Alleluia! The Lord is risen indeed!" (Ancient Easter greeting) "My Lord and My God" (John 20:28)

- a. The Risen and Triumphant Lamb of God (Agnus Dei) stands victorious before the Cross of death. The rays of glorious light reflect off the Circle, reminding us that His victory is forever.
- b. The Lily symbolizes the Resurrection by reminding us that a bulb dying in the soil produces a new bulb, stem, leaves, and flowers, all rising in glory above the darkness of the soil; signifying the attainment of immortal life though the body perishes.
- c. The Phoenix, the mythical bird which at death bursts into flames but rises from its own ashes, symbolizes Christ's resurrection, and our immortal life in Him.
- d. The Bursting Pomegranate, split by the pressure of its many seeds, symbolizes the power to reproduce life. It also symbolizes the new life for all people in Christ's bursting forth from death.
- e. The Butterfly, leaving its "tomb" in the pupa, soars upward symbolizing Christ's Resurrection, and that through Christ His followers are borne to a new life.

Jesus Christ the Victor: The Greek Cross, the first and last letters of the Greek words for Jesus Christ, and the Greek word NIKA, meaning "victor".

VII. The Ascension Window. "Christ the Lord has Ascended Into Heaven" (Ancient Ascension greeting) "And He shall reign forever and ever!" (Revelation 11:15)

- a. The Fiery Chariot is an ancient symbol of our Lord's Ascension; taken from the Old Testament, "Behold there appeared a chariot of fire . . . and Elijah went up by a whirlwind into Heaven." (II Kings 2:11)

- b. The Christus Victor contains: (i) The Cross with a RHO at the top symbolizes the Greek letters CHI-RHO, the first letters in the name Jesus Christ. (ii) The Greek letter N for NIKA, which means "victor". Thus, "Christ the Victor" (Christus Victor).
- c. The Cross of Triumph symbolizes the reign of Christ over all the world.
- d. The Crown and Scepter are symbols of Christ's reign in heaven and on earth.

VIII. The Pentecost Window. "They were with one accord in one place." "And they were filled with the Holy Spirit." (Acts 2:1-4)

- a. The central figures in this window are two of the most ancient and most used symbols for Pentecost.
- i. The Descending Dove comes directly from the Baptism of our Lord, when "the heavens opened and the Spirit descended upon Him like a dove" (Matthew 3:13-17; Mark 1:9-11; Luke 3:21-22). This same Spirit – The Third Person of the Trinity – came upon the Disciples at Pentecost (Acts 2:1-4), and comes upon us at our Baptism when we are made members of Christ's Church. The Nimbus with three rays circling the head of the Dove signifies divinity.
- ii. The Seven Flames remind us that when the Spirit came upon the Disciples at Pentecost "there appeared to them tongues as of fire . . . resting on each of them" (Acts 2:3). The number seven symbolizes the seven gifts of the Spirit: Power, Riches, Wisdom, Strength, Honor, Glory, and Blessing (Revelation 5:12). The gifts of the Spirit referred to in the Confirmation service (Prayer Book, Page 297) are: Grace, Wisdom, Understanding, Council, Ghostly strength, Knowledge, True Godliness (Isaiah 11:2).
- b. The Ten Commandments on Tables of Stone remind us of our heritage from the Old Testament. Pentecost means "fiftieth" day, and was the Jewish Feast of Weeks (Thanksgiving for the grain harvest). It was also a commemoration of the giving of the Law on Mount Sinai, and thus the foundation of "the Jewish Church."
- c. The Tower of Babel reminds us that when men tried to build a tower into heaven (Genesis 11:1-9) – that is to "storm God's throne" – they were scattered across the face of the earth and their language was confused. At the Christian Pentecost the Power of the Holy Spirit inspired the Apostles to speak in a manner that all men understood (Acts 2:5-11). The name Babel = Babylon ("gate of God"). The Hebrews used this word to mean "to confuse", "to mix".
- d. The Ship is an ancient symbol for the Church, which came into being at Pentecost. The Ship sails unharmed through all perils. The word "Nave" comes from the Latin word for

"ship".

- e. The Vine symbolizes Christ as the source of life for the "Branches", the Church. "I am the Vine, you are the Branches" (John 15:5)

Note: The English and other northern European peoples called the Day of Pentecost WHITSUNDAY ("White Sunday") from the white garments worn by the newly baptized on this day. "The Feast of the Coming of The Holy Spirit" has long been an appropriate day for Baptism.

Editor's note on corrections

This edition follows the original book exactly in every fact, date, name, and quotation. Only these plain typographical slips in the original were corrected so the text reads cleanly:

- "Willliam F. Freeman" → "William F. Freeman"; "Hight Point" → "High Point" (columbarium).
- "to provided a reredos" → "to provide a reredos"; "When is was approved" → "When it was approved" (reredos).
- "The turned out to be" → "They turned out to be" (Saint James Brass).
- "more of less than" → "more or less than" (missal stand).
- "A Cross us emblazoned" → "A Cross is emblazoned" (Christ Window).
- "respectivly" → "respectively"; "St. Mathew" → "St. Matthew" (seasonal windows).
- "he first letter" → "the first letters" and balanced the parenthesis in the Christian Window's item (c), which read "(and HIS, the first letters ... CHI RHO, he first letter ...)".
- "a ledge to assure us" → "a pledge to assure us" (Sacramental Windows; "pledge" is the Prayer Book wording).
- In the altar-cross note, the original prints "HIS" for the first three Greek letters of "Jesus"; rendered consistently as "IHS" to match the same book's own usage two paragraphs earlier.

The original's own spellings and wordings have otherwise been left untouched, including period usages such as "Botonic"/"Bontonee," "escallop," "Litchfield," "Terrisa," and the gifts of the Spirit as the book lists them ("Council," "Ghostly strength").